When a villain falls for the hero

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/44870620.

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Mature

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence, Major Character Death

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Catra/Scorpia (She-Ra), Catra & Double Trouble (She-Ra), Kyle/Lonnie/Rogelio (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Angella/Micah (She-Ra), Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Superheroes/Superpowers, Catra Has Issues (She-Ra), supervillain catra, Mentioned Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner's A+ Parenting

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When a villain falls for the hero

by NeurodivergentCatra

Summary

Catra is one of the biggest supervillains Etheria has seen. During a plan to get rid of She-Ra, things go very wrong, and Catra finds herself obsessed with the hero.

The Dryl Device

Catra glanced across the crowded room at a painting of lightning striking a golden sword. It would be her next heist. Her henchmen gave the all clear signal and she strolled across the room, finishing off her champagne. Catra counted to five while she waited for the distraction to occur, giving her time to get away with the painting. As she counted five in her head, an explosion rocked the museum hall, and she quickly cut the painting from the frame and dashed to the fire escape, yet tonight would not be so easy. Brightmoon's own superhero, She-Ra, was there to "save the day."

This was Catra's first time ever seeing She-Ra in person, and no camera or story could ever do She-Ra's beauty justice. After reminding herself She-Ra is a hero, Catra shook her mind from the thought and dashed in the opposite direction, hoping She-Ra had not seen her. Unfortunately for Catra, She-Ra caught up to Catra quickly.

"Return the painting, Crimson Cat!" She-Ra's deep voice demanded.

"No." Catra said before sticking out her tongue and jumping backwards into the street, only to land in a van with an open side door and start her getaway. "Kyle, lose her!"

"On it!" the driver yelled from the driver's seat. Catra saw She-Ra gaining ground and nodded to Rogelio, who grabbed a rocket launcher off the floor of the van and leaned out the door. He shot it at She-Ra's feet, which sent her flying backwards into the air. As soon as Catra was sure they had lost the hero tail, they drove

towards their forest hideout, a cave system underneath the forest that had been remodeled into a villain's lair. Catra hopped out with the painting, and hung it on the wall.

"What do you think?"

"It's great, Catra!" Kyle exclaimed, saluting Catra as she walked away from the painting to get a better look.

"I don't think it matches the vibe of this room. Unfortunate." She sighed before tossing a lit match at the painting, her pupils growing large as she witnessed the painting go up into flames. Then, she got a call.

"Darling, thank you for disabling She-Ra for the night! I had no problem leaving the bank!" Double Trouble squealed.

"Didn't realize we incapacitated her." Catra stated. She gave Rogelio a high five and went back to the call. "I knew she'd be on my heels for the painting. Penelope Rose painted that after She-Ra defeated Shadow Weaver."

"Once again, thank you but I simply must be going! I have other business to attend to tonight!"

"What next, ma'am?" Kyle asked after the call ended.

“We’re heading to Dryl. Supposedly, some scientist accidentally built a weapon of mass destruction, and we need to get to it before the government does!”

“How do we know about it before the government?” Lonnie asked, emerging from another room.

“I inherited all of Mother’s old stuff when She-Ra ended her, including her many spies in many places. Best day of my life, that bitch dies and I get all her stuff.” Catra stated in a colder, harsher tone. That shut everyone up, and they began preparing the van for the journey to Dryl.

////

“So, Entrapta was trying to build a supercomputer and ended up with a bomb?” Lonnie asked.

Catra shrugged. “Yeah, that about sums it up.”

“Lovely.”

“Okay team, we’re almost to Dryl. We’re more than likely going to be facing off against the Golden Archer, he’s Dryl’s resident hero.

His arrows are almost always gadgets, so watch for gooey arrows and EMP arrows."

"So, how are we getting a supercomputer bomb out of the facility?"

Catra pulled out a bunch of military uniforms and distributed them to the crew. "Courtesy of the Major. We're going to put these on and pretend to be the military extraction crew. As soon as I give the signal, we'll knock out the guards and make Entrapta tell us how to get it out of there without setting it off. If Arrow Boy shows up, I'll handle him."

They walked in and showed their fake military IDs, and nobody caught on. They walked Catra and her crew into the facility, where Entrapta was waiting. "Hello, Captain, we're just getting the device ready for transportation!"

"Great, how soon will we be on the road?"

"With no interference, 10 minutes. We're transferring it into the ice box now."

"Ice box?"

"The device will explode if it reaches 80 degrees fahrenheit, so I'm putting it into a machine that will keep it well below zero, just

to be safe. Although that won't completely disarm it, so try not to hit any major bumps or anything. Any form of impact could set it off!" Entrapta rambled.

"Perfect!" Catra announced, before shooting one of the guards and aiming her pistol at Entrapta. Before the other guards could react, Lonnie, Kyle, and Rogelio shot them. Entrapta froze. "Take me to the 'ice box'" Catra demanded. Entrapta began walking slowly deeper into the facility. "Alert anyone, and I empty this clip into you." Catra hissed. Her pistol sat pointed between Entrapta's shoulder blades. Catra began feeling cold, and smiled. Entrapta scanned her ID card on the door, and it opened to reveal a black rectangular device about 5 feet tall and three feet wide being lowered by a crane into a 6 foot by 6 foot metal box where cold steam spewed. As soon as the machines closed the device into the 'ice box', Catra whipped the back of Entrapta's head with the pistol rendering her unconscious. Her crew disengaged the locks on the wheels beneath the ice box, and pushed it out into the hallway. They ran for the entrance, when an arrow with a golden shaft whizzed past Catra and stuck into the ground next to Kyle's feet. Catra stopped and smiled towards the ceiling where the arrow had come from.

"Hey, Arrow Boy! You are more than welcome to come after me, but I should let you know Entrapta is freezing to death in the Ice Box room. Will you save her, or stop me? Choose wisely!" She called into the air with bravado before running again to catch up with her team. They had already begun wheeling the box into the van. As soon as it was secure, Kyle slammed on the gas and the van disappeared into the night. Catra had won again. After they had returned to the Crimson Lair, Catra had Lonnie scan the box and the device for trackers, and changed into her civilian clothes to blend in, a System of a Down t-shirt, a black leather jacket, and some torn black jeans.

She hopped into her red volvo s60, (She had to blend in somehow, but just had to have a red car.) and drove into Thunder City. Her destination was a hotel by the name of "the Enchanted Grotto." Major Lynda Scorpia liked to stay there when she wasn't on base. As she walked into the crowded lobby, Catra became immediately overwhelmed by the many sounds from the blaring music to the thousands of conversations. She hurried to the elevator and hit the button for the fifth floor. She went to the end of the hallway and knocked on the door to her left. Major Scorpia opened it and smiled.

"Come on in!" Lynn cheered. As soon as the door closed, Catra's face changed from neutral to a grin.

"So, thanks for the fits, the plan worked like a charm!"

"So I heard. You caused quite a ruckus, being able to so easily disarm the archer."

"Guess you could say I'm a cold ass bitch." Catra sneered, and both of them erupted into laughter. "So how was your day, hun?"

"I sang downstairs for a bit, won and lost some cash at the poker table, and drank a couple glasses of whiskey. A typical day off." Lynn responded, and they scooted closer to each other, before making out. The tension had been so high that by the time Lynn lifted Catra to carry her into the bedroom, they were already mostly clothesless.

/////

The next morning, Catra woke up feeling pretty refreshed and put on her jacket and some underwear and strolled into the kitchen. As she left the bedroom, her nose picked up the strong scent of pancakes. “Aww, you didn’t have to!”

“Well, I wanted to! It’s not like we get to spend much time together these days between my military career and your supervillain career. Speaking of which, what’s your plan for the Dryl device?”

“Dunno yet. Could strap it to Mayor Moon, or I could use it to get rid of a hero. I’m cooking up a plan that might let me do both!”

“Sounds thrilling! You want syrup and/or butter?”

“Butter, no syrup. It always gets all up in my fur and it isn’t a pleasant experience.”

“How about you, when do you deploy next?”

“Well, don’t tell anyone,” Scorpia winked, “but I’m gonna be on the security detail for Mayor Moon’s presidential campaign.”

“Oh my god, Lynn! That’s great!” Catra squealed, and her face turned mischievous and her voice dropped before adding, “for both of us.”

/////

Catra hated crawling around in vents, but she couldn’t miss the opportunity to spy on Mayor Micah Moon on her own. His office looked smaller from the vent above, Catra noted. Most of her day was pretty boring. Moon only had a few visitors that morning, his daughter, Glimmer came in before breakfast to talk about how life would change for her once Moon becomes president. He spoke with a television executive next, discussing the amount of money to be put into tv ads, and the last appointment before noon was with a security advisor about tonight’s announcement dinner, where he would announce his run for president on live television. Catra kept a closer ear on this conversation, just in case she wanted to crash the party later. Then, at noon he left for lunch. Catra decided she would leave now too, given she had to pee and that it didn’t seem like she would be getting much useful intel anyways. She wiggled her way back to the vent exit on the roof and watched as Moon’s pretentious purple limousine headed out of the parking lot and turned north, probably taking Moon to some fancy restaurant downtown. As soon as she was sure she wouldn't be seen, she jumped from the roof into a nearby bush.

She was heading back to the Crimson Lair, but it wouldn’t hurt to visit DT on her way there. She took a detour down 13th street to a little hole-in-the-wall bar called Darkmoon. Catra chuckled at the lack of creativity and the knowledge that the mayor would go ballistic if he knew about it. She walked inside and eyed the three

people in the bar. The bartender was a muscular blonde man, and he had been washing a glass. In two of the four booths, there were drunks who sat alone. One was asleep, the other was crying. Catra sat on a stool at the bar and winked at the bartender. He smiled back, revealing teeth that looked to be razor sharp, and handed Catra a whole bottle of Vodka. “Thanks, DT!”

The bartender laughed before transforming into a green, lizard-like humanoid. “Little early to be drinking on a Sunday.” they commented.

“I’ll be taking it to go. Just wanted to stop by and see if you needed anything.”

“What I *need* is for She-Ra to back off my ass. Every time I try to do anything fun, she stops me. Also ever since you ended her win streak, she’s been grilling every goon in the city. She’s looking for you.”

“Poor She-Ra, sounds like she’s obsessed. Not a good look on a hero.” Catra laughed maniacally. “Although… I doubt she’ll be bothering us much longer.”

It all goes horribly wrong

Chapter Summary

> Catra sets her plan in motion, but it doesn't work out very well for her.

“To all of my friends in Bright Moon who got me to where I am, thank you. I hope my run for president brings as much wealth and popularity to the rest of our city as the presidential seat will bring to me.” Micah announced, clearly reading the paper someone else had written for him. Not many of the citizens noticed, though. Catra just glared from the entrance to the large hotel, waiting for Kyle to radio that the device was in position. She also scanned the tops of the nearby buildings for heroes (mainly She-Ra.)

“Hey, Catra, all clear!” Kyle whispered through the radio. Catra grinned and walked around the crowd to the stage. Once she made her way backstage, a guard tried to stop her, who received a silenced bullet through the chest very quickly. Glimmer was in the room, unexpectedly, but Catra figured this was even better.

Before Glimmer could speak, Catra grabbed her and pointed the gun at her head. “Keep quiet, Moon. You’ll ruin the big surprise!” she whispered into Glimmer’s ear. She brought Glimmer downstairs to the boiler room of the building, and tied Glimmer to the large black box that had been placed there.

Once the gun was no longer pointed at her head, Glimmer spoke up. “What exactly is the plan here, Crimson?”

"You'll see." Catra responded, before turning to a nearby computer Kyle had set up. She activated it, and turned on the camera.

///// *Upstairs, one minute earlier*

"Glimmer?" Micah called, having finished his speech. He walked behind the stage curtain, and was immediately horrified by what he saw. The bodyguard was slaughtered and his daughter was now missing. He immediately grabbed his phone and called for his backup personal bodyguard. He entered the digits written on the card the army general had given him. "I was told to call this number if something happened to my current bodyguard. Are you Major Scorpia?"

"Yes, that's me. I'll be downstairs in a minute. Are you in immediate danger?" Major Scorpia asked.

"No, but my daughter is!" Micah responded.

"Stay exactly where you are, Mr. Moon." Major Scorpia ordered, hanging up the phone. Just then, the crowd gasped in shock. Micah ran out onstage to see what was going on, and noticed two large screens descending from the ceiling. On each screen was the Crimson Cat, one of Bright Moon's most notorious supervillains, and she was laughing.

"Attention Bright Moon, especially Mayor Moon. I have Glimmer Moon," the villain announced. She pointed her gun at Glimmer on

screen for extra dramatic effect. “And she’s strapped to the lovely device I stole from Dryl two weeks ago. If She-Ra doesn’t show up within the next half an hour, the girl dies, and this bomb destroys the entirety of downtown Bright Moon.” She laughed maniacally again before the screens cut the feed.

Major Scorpia and her squad arrived at this time, and extracted Mayor Moon to his limousine quickly, and drove him away, pointing assault rifles at anyone in the way. Many of Bright Moon’s residents screamed and ran, trying their best to escape the downtown area.

///// *The basement*

Catra destroyed the computer and turned back to Glimmer. She duct taped Glimmer’s mouth shut, and whispered, “Just so you don’t get any funny ideas or call for help.” and then she ran, leaving Glimmer alone and strapped to one of the deadliest bombs Etheria had ever created. She ran out the back doors of the hotel to where her getaway was supposed to be in the alley, but was instead met with a fist to the face.

“Where is she!?” the Golden Archer demanded angrily.

“Bite me.” Catra responded, slowly getting back to her feet. He tried to throw another punch, but Catra swept his legs out from under him with a kick and then sank her claws into his chest. “You’re not even the hero I was looking to kill today. Guess I’ll call it a two-for-one.” She teased, before landing the hardest punch she could manage to his masked face. After knocking him

unconscious with the blow, she ran to her backup plan, a scarlet motorcycle parked in an alley two blocks over. She vaulted cars on the street with ease and made it to her bike in less than a minute. As soon as she was on it, she called Kyle.

"As soon as I am clear of the blast zone, blow it!" She ordered.

"Yes, ma'am!" Kyle responded.

She got to the city limit, where the trees of the Whispering Woods began to come into view. She thought she had won, but suddenly a vine grew across the road, catching the front tire of the bike and sending Catra flying. She hit the pavement, and with the pain she was pretty sure she had either fractured or broken her left arm. She tried to stand, but couldn't. She had been going at least 70 mph, and being flung from her bike left her with extensive injuries. She looked to where the vine had come from and 4 people stepped out. Queen Green (definitely the source of the rogue vine), Snow Wrecker, Neptune, and She-Ra.

"Wow," Catra groaned, coughing up a bit of blood before continuing, "the whole super squad for little ol' me."

"Enough of your games, Cat." She-Ra demanded. Catra didn't really hear her though, she was too busy staring at She-Ra's muscles, which were so defined you could probably see them from space. Being up close, Catra could tell She-Ra was at least 8 feet tall. She stood 2 feet higher than the other heroes. If she wasn't Catra's enemy, she would be starstruck.

“Where are Glimmer Moon and the Golden Archer?” Snow Wrecker asked. Just then, the explosion rocked the ground beneath them, causing all the heroes except She-Ra to lose their balance and fall to the ground. The heroes watched in horror as the tallest buildings of the city crumbled. She-Ra turned back around to the Crimson Cat, but much to her surprise the only thing she saw was a puddle of blood, and a trail of red leading deeper into the dense forest. She-Ra let out a frustrated scream and then regained her composure. “Queen Green, let’s go after the cat. Snow Wrecker, Neptune, go help the citizens of Bright Moon.” she ordered.

///// *Half an hour later*

Catra stumbled through the forest trying to reach her underground lair. She would’ve called for backup, but her phone and radio were both smashed in the motorcycle crash. She must have lost too much blood though, because she felt like she was going to pass out. She found a rock to slump against in a clearing, and slowly slid to the ground. She took off her mask in an attempt to breathe better, but it didn’t help much. Then, right before her vision faded to black, she noticed two figures walking up to her.

Aftermath

Chapter Summary

Catra is rescued from the hospital and hides out in Seaworthy

When Catra woke up, she was in some sort of hospital bed. The beeping of the heart rate monitor and the smell of disinfectant confirmed she was in a hospital. She tried to move, but couldn't. She looked down and realized even if her body was working, she still wouldn't be going anywhere. Each of her wrists were handcuffed to the bed, as were her ankles. As soon as her vision adjusted to the bright lights in her room, she noticed a large figure standing over her.

"Oh good, you're awake. That means I get to see you live out your days in maximum security." She-Ra hissed. "But, before that, I've got some things to ask you, Catra Weaver."

"Oh, you *do* know my real name. When did you learn it, now or when you killed my mother?" Catra snarled.

She-Ra reached over and turned up the noise for the heart rate monitor. Catra's sensitive ears began to ring a little, unable to deal with the loud noise so close. "Where is the Golden Archer?" She-Ra's deep and commanding voice asked.

"I don't remember. Most things before the motorcycle accident are pretty fuzzy. Speaking of which, how long was I out?"

“About a week.” She-Ra responded bluntly. She leaned over and turned the sound for the heart monitor down to the normal level. “I’ll be back tonight. Let’s hope you remember by then.” She-Ra threatened before ducking into the hallway.

If it wouldn’t hurt to laugh, Catra would have chuckled at how She-Ra’s ridiculous height made her too tall to walk through any door without crouching. The next hour was pretty boring. Catra couldn’t really move much, and the TV was off and she was alone. She had no idea where she was though, because she was 99% sure she leveled Bright Moon Hospital with the bomb. She spent the entirety of the next hour thinking about She-Ra’s muscles and piercing blue eyes. Then, a nurse came in to “check her vitals.” The nurse set her clipboard down, and after making sure no one else was coming down the hallway, shapeshifted back into their normal, lizard-like form. “You okay, darling?” Double Trouble asked.

“Other than being unable to move?”

“Yeah, those damn heroes got you good. On the bright side, your plan kind of worked. Mayor Moon is in hiding, the Golden Archer is missing/presumed dead, and She-Ra is so busy trying to take care of what’s left of Bright Moon *and* Dryl that she’s not bothering me too much. Oh, and you killed over two thousand people. Bright Moon is in *chaos* ! I love it!” Double Trouble squealed. After receiving nothing but a glare from Catra, Double Trouble sighed. “Fine, you want me to get you out of here?”

“Yeah, just drop me off at the bunker, I’ve got enough pain pills and supplies to hide there until I can walk again.”

“About that…”

“What?”

“Well, they found it. The heroes. Your crew is still on the loose, but they confiscated everything.”

“Great.” Catra muttered.

“Don’t worry, darling. I’ll get you out of here though.” Double Trouble assured her. Double Trouble shapeshifted into a police officer. A big fat one with blonde hair and blue eyes. They pushed the bed down the hall and into the elevator. The alarm started blaring, as someone must have noticed Catra was missing. Double Trouble hit the roof button on the elevator and wheeled the bed out to a helicopter that was waiting. Some large buff guys Double Trouble must have hired jumped out of the helicopter and lifted the bed onto the helicopter and hopped back in, and Double Trouble jumped into the co-pilot seat. Some police officers made their way onto the roof and started shooting. Double Trouble sighed, “No respect for my helicopter I see.” and grabbed an assault rifle and began spraying shots back as the helicopter began to fly off. They flew for hours, it felt like. Then, the pilot announced, “Approaching Seaworthy!” Seaworthy was packed with bars, of which Double Trouble owned 3. They landed on top of one of the hotels overlooking the ocean. Double Trouble ended up giving Catra the apartment above one of the bars, it had a really nice view and was stocked with all the pain meds and alcohol Catra could ever ask for.

///// A month later

Catra's road to recovery was a long one. A month had passed, but Catra could still only walk with the use of a cane. Her back hurt like hell no matter how much vodka she drank or pain meds she took. Using her cane, she hobbled over to the couch to watch some TV.

"The search for Catra Weaver, AKA the Crimson Cat, continues. She has not been seen since disappearing from Ridgeline Hospital in Dryl about a month ago. If you have any information on her whereabouts, contact this number." The news reporter announced. Catra hissed. The other news anchor continued with the next story, "In other news, President-Elect Micah Moon celebrates his victory with the promise to rebuild Bright Moon by the end of next year."

Catra sighed and turned off the tv. She used her cane to get up and made her way over to the mirror. She was covered in scars from the motorcycle crash. Somehow, she managed to regain control of all of her body except her left leg, which sent a stinging pain response every time she put any form of pressure on it. She wore a black hoodie and black leggings, and a recovery boot on her left foot. Her hair was longer than ever before, and she looked as much of a mess as she felt. She did it, she blew up Bright Moon. However, every day she wondered if it was really worth it. She was confined to a small apartment in Seaworthy, no company outside of the occasional check up from DT. She missed her crew, she missed her home, and she missed the thrill of her villainous plans. Strangely, she also missed She-Ra. She spent hours per day looking at pictures and videos of her on the internet as she fought other villains. She also missed her girlfriend. Lynn had no idea where Catra was, because Double Trouble wanted Catra to be as

off the radar as possible. Catra thought about reaching out anyways, but she didn't want Lynn to see her like this. She didn't want *anyone* to see her like this. Barely able to walk, scars and gashes in every part of her body. She had also been drinking a bottle of vodka every day, and looked and smelled the part. What a victory, right?

Just then, Double Trouble decided to stop by. "Knock Knock, Darling!"

"You do know saying 'knock knock' is not the same as knocking, right?"

"Feisty this evening! Love this!"

"Whatever. Did you bring more vodka?"

"No, the shipment is late. I did bring whiskey though!"

"I'll take it." Catra muttered.

"So, I came up here because I have a gift for you."

"Finally, we get to the point."

“If you could not be bitchy for two seconds, please.” Double Trouble retorted, “I kidnapped Entrapta last week and I had her build a mechanical leg to replace your bum one.”

“Do we really have to cyborg me?”

“Do you want to walk again?”

“Fine.”

A new kind of life

Chapter Summary

> Double Trouble forces Catra to work for them as payment for the apartment, and her new leg. Catra doesn't let it slide for long.

Catra woke up in a strange, dark room. She immediately sprung to her feet, ready to fight whatever brought her there. “Wait, am I *walking* ?” she questioned, realizing she just landed on her feet without any pain. Then, her memory started to return. She looked down and inspected her new robotic leg. She would probably feel pain later, but DT would definitely have put her on the strongest pain meds. She practiced walking with the leg for about half an hour, and then Double Trouble walked in and the lights turned on.

“Glad to see your operation went well!” Double Trouble exclaimed, “Now we can cause some real chaos.”

“Of course. You had plans for me this whole time.”

“You didn’t seriously think the room, alcohol, and leg were for free, did you?” Double Trouble asked rhetorically. Catra’s ears lowered. She had been used. “Let’s see if we can actually manage to kill She-Ra this time.”

“You got it, Boss.” Catra muttered sarcastically.

///// Dryl, 2 days later

Catra waltzed into the bank with one of DT's powerful rifles, and immediately shot the guard. "So, here's the deal. You give me all your money, or I do to this town what I did to Bright Moon." she announced. The tellers quickly led her to the safe and opened it, before running for their lives. Catra may not be in charge anymore or nearly as happy as she once was, but the feeling of people running from her in terror never got old. She stuffed as much cash as she could into two bags and fled, one in each hand. The point of this robbery was not the money, but to show the world Catra was back. She-Ra would undoubtedly come for vengeance after hearing of Catra's return. She hopped into an old school charger DT had provided and sped off. She arrived at one of DT's garages and jumped out of the car. "That was fun, I missed this." she sighed to herself before turning on the small tv in the crowded garage. The news is exactly what she and DT had hoped for.

"Breaking news: Catra Weaver, also known as the Crimson Cat, has returned to her life of crime after being in hiding for over a month. She stole upwards of ten thousand dollars from the World Bank in Dryl this afternoon. If you see her, call 911." The reporter announced. Catra did not like her real face being shown on the news so much, because that meant she could never go anywhere again without risking being caught again or worse, if She-Ra finds her. She grabbed the burner phone DT had left her and dialed Lynn's number. It rang, but went to voicemail. Catra sighed. Then, she called DT.

"DT, it's done."

“I know, Darling! Good work. As soon as it gets dark, come over to the tavern.”

After dark, Catra crept out of the back door to the garage, and snuck through the alleys of the city trying to avoid being seen. Hiding behind dumpsters to avoid cops felt weird. Before everything happened, she would stroll right past them or shoot them if in Crimson Cat attire. She missed being fearless. And now she was just one of Double Trouble’s pawns in their eternal game of chaos. She could run, try to track down her old crew, and try to climb back to where she was, yet everyone knew her face and crossing DT was a death sentence. Taking on the heroes, the villains and the public didn’t appeal to her. So, she snuck into the tavern and into DT’s office.

“You having fun yet, Mrs. Weaver?” DT teased. Working for DT was one thing, but Catra *hated* being called Weaver.

“Fuck you.” she responded.

“You wish you could.” Double Trouble responded.

“What do you want me to do next, your Highness?”

“Well, Tung Lashor is supposedly in town to recruit more followers. If you could let him know whose city this is?”

“My pleasure.” Catra responded. She hated Tung Lashor. What kind of clown gives himself a name like that anyway? She headed towards the high school, almost knowing Lashor would be trying to take a page out of the Army’s playbook. Sure enough, there he was giving a speech to a group of high schoolers on campus in the middle of the night. Then, she had an idea. One that might just get her out of multiple situations. She retrieved the rifle from the bank heist from her backpack, and aimed down the sights. The shot echoed through the night, and Tung Lashor collapsed to the ground. The teenagers ran off, leaving an empty street and a dead body. Catra decided that doing something good for once wasn’t the worst thing in the world. If only she could find a way to take out Double Trouble, she could get out of this life, retire in Seaworthy, perhaps. She left a note next to Lashor’s body.

“You’re welcome, Dryl.”

Three months ago, Catra would never have dreamed of being a vigilante or a hero. Now, here she sat pondering a new name. She felt better than she had in a long time after doing something good. She found herself questioning why she was ever even a villain in the first place. Sure, she was no saint and was responsible for the deaths of thousands, but that didn’t mean she had to stay horrible, right?

She stopped at a local gun store that she had used in the past. The man behind the counter recognized her, and laughed. “Crimson? Thought you were dead.”

“So did most. Mind if I take that long-range rifle?”

“No chitchat?” he complained. “Yeah, sure. That sniper is a beauty, ain’t she?”

Catra nodded, and emptied the cash out of her backpack. She thanked the salesman and went to the building across the street from the tavern. DT crossed her, and Catra would not let that slide. She climbed to the roof of the other building and waited. After an hour, Double Trouble stepped out. They stretched and barked commands at the bikers outside. Catra smiled, and pulled the trigger.

Catra goes back to Bright Moon

Chapter Summary

> Catra goes back to Bright Moon to look for her old crew, and meets a beautiful woman she instantly falls for. This woman ropes her into helping with the reconstruction effort in Bright Moon, and Catra doesn't mind.

Catra sat in her old base of operations, sitting in front of a mirror. If she wanted to blend in, try to make a new life for herself, she was going to have to change her appearance. As much as she hated doing so, she cut off her mane. It had been about a week since she had gotten her revenge on Double Trouble, and she didn’t really have a plan for what to do next. After killing two villains, she probably wouldn’t be welcomed back into the crime world very easily. After killing thousands in Bright Moon, she definitely wouldn’t be accepted into the mainstream world. She found an old pair of blue-rimmed sunglasses that would cover up her very easily identifiable mismatched eyes, and put them on. The lair was a disaster, after being raided by the heroes and then the police. It was pretty evident it would take awhile to restore it if Catra wanted to use it again. She wasn’t sure if she wanted to, though. It had been one of the many properties she inherited from her evil mother, after all.

She began the hike towards Bright Moon. Walking through the woods was more peaceful than her life had ever been. It was quiet, but not too quiet. It was a warm day, but the trees left Catra in the shade as she walked. If Catra could have this life forever, she would. No stress, no fights, and no good or evil. Now that Double Trouble was gone, she was free to hide and make herself a new, *normal* life.

As the sun began to set, the trees gave way to a massive city. Catra had made it to Bright Moon. As she walked, she saw the damage she had done to this city with her own eyes. Some buildings outside the blast zone had collapsed due to the earthquake the bomb had caused, and there were homeless people everywhere. Anybody who didn't make it out of the city or didn't have the money to move or had lost all of their possessions that day. She felt her ears go flat against her head. She put her head down and ducked into an alley. ` *What am I doing here?'* She asked herself. She hoped she'd find Kyle or someone who could arrange a new identity for her, but she had no idea where to look, if any of those people were even in Bright Moon. Just as she was about to think about catching a bus out of town, a big burly lizard man walked into the alley.

"Give me your wallet and no one gets hurt, kitten." he said. Catra chuckled, and took off her sunglasses. He recognized her immediately and backed up against the opposing building, almost cowering. "Forget I said anything, please."

"Go. If I catch you threatening girls in alleyways ever again though…" Catra trailed off, unsheathing her claws. The man scurried off, as if he were running for his life. Catra put her sunglasses back on and ducked into the nearest bar.

They were watching a football game, Dryl Darts vs Salineas Sharks. Catra couldn't care less and sat at the bar and ordered a shot of whiskey. Then, a woman sat next to her. Catra had to stop her mouth from dropping open. The woman was beautiful. Her hair was blonde and free-flowing. Her eyes were a calm grayish blue. Her muscles showing underneath her red-plaid jacket and worn out jeans made Catra think she must be a farmworker.

“Hey, Johnny, whatever the lady wants, on my tab.” Catra called in a playful, high-pitched voice. Catra caught herself off guard on how different that voice sounded from her normal deep, gruff voice. The woman next to her laughed.

“Not even gonna ask for my name first?” the woman teased. Her voice sounded familiar to Catra, but she couldn’t place it. “I’m Adora Grey, and you are…?”

“Selina Kyle.” Catra blurted out, not having thought of a name prior. She felt stupid, referencing the comic book character, but she didn’t have any other ideas soon enough.

“Well, nice to meet you, Selina.” Adora responded cheerfully. “So what brings you here?”

Catra knew the most convincing stories are just versions of the truth, so that's what she told Adora. “Some friends of mine lived here before that horrid day. I came to see if I could track them down, if they’re still alive.”

“Oh, I’m sorry to hear that.” Adora replied, briefly lowering her gaze. They were briefly interrupted by the crowd cheering and/or yelling about a goalie catching the ball.

“How about you, Adora? What’s a beautiful, muscular woman like you doing in a bar like this?” Catra quickly changed the topic.

“Oh, I volunteered to help with the reconstruction efforts.”

Catra thought for a moment, and then began to form a plan. “You know where I can sign up? I might not be able to find my friends but I might as well do some good while I’m in town.”

Adora’s eyes widened, and then she exclaimed, “Sure, I’ll take you there.” After finishing their drinks, they headed towards the upper class district of Bright Moon, which had been hit the hardest. “Thanks for the drink, Selina,” Adora said as they walked.

“No problem, beautiful.” Catra flirted. Adora must have just now realized Catra had been flirting this whole time because her face turned red. Catra sneezed, causing Adora to laugh.

“Oh my goodness, that is the cutest sneeze I have ever heard!” Adora chuckled.

“I am *not* cute!” Catra retorted.

“Sure, whatever.” Adora said, smiling brighter.

They had walked into the area of town where very few buildings were still standing. Catra shuddered, looking at the ruins. “Wow.” she muttered.

“Yeah, it’s kind of depressing, huh?” Adora sighed.

“Yeah.” Catra responded, her mind filling with regret.

They arrived at a building that looked very new, in contrast to the ruins of all the other buildings in the area. It was 4 stories tall. They walked in, and there were a couple clerks who were handing out contracts. “So, they offer a room in this building in return for a month’s worth of reconstruction help, which can be renewed at the end of your stay.” Adora explained. Catra nodded and walked over to a desk clerk.

She signed the contract under her new false identity, Selina Kyle, and was given an old flip phone for work-purposes and the key to a room on the third floor. She turned around to thank Adora, but she was gone. Catra pouted the whole way to her room. She opened the door, locked it, and flopped onto the bed, exhausted. It was a nice, cozy little room. The bed was a queen mattress with a very comfortable blanket, and there was a bathroom on one side and a small kitchen on the other, and a window next to the bed. She set her sunglasses on the bedside table and threw off her clothes. She unpacked the sniper and her spare set of clothes from her bag. She tucked the sniper underneath the bathroom sink and folded her black leather jacket, and jeans and put them aside before crawling into bed. Things would be alright like this. She would get to help with the reconstruction and hopefully redeem herself along the way. Even if she wasn’t ever going to be viewed that way by the public, it mattered to her.

Super Squad confrontations

Chapter Summary

> Catra manages to drunkenly convince two Super Squad members that she isn't the same person as she used to be. If you haven't noticed, this story takes inspiration from the Joker's story in Harley Quinn.

The next few weeks were pretty simple for Catra. She got used to responding to Selina or Ms. Kyle pretty quickly and she just kept quiet and helped rebuild. She mostly finished concrete but it wasn’t a horrible job, especially when there were ice chests full of water and monster energy drinks for the workers to consume while working. She always wore her sunglasses though and kept her hair really short. She even dyed it a darker black about a week into her new life.

One night, after work, she went back to the bar near the city limits she had found Adora at three weeks ago. To her surprise, Adora was there. She sat at the stool next to her, and Adora smiled when she recognized her. “Johnny, it’s my turn to buy Selina a drink!” Adora called to the bartender. Catra laughed. “So, how’s it going?”

“It’s actually pretty great. They take pretty good care of us workers, and I’m probably going to get another contract when this one expires.” Catra responded.

“I’m glad to hear it.” Adora responded.

“We’re gonna start rebuilding that Grand Hotel soon, that’ll probably be less fun, given I am not a fan of heights.” Catra continued. Adora flinched at the mention of the hotel, but then again most people in Bright Moon did, given it was the center of the blast, so Catra dismissed it.

“You’re scared of heights?”

“I never said ‘scared’!” Catra replied, to which Adora chuckled. Catra yawned, having worked all day, and wrote her cell number on a napkin and slid it over to Adora. “It’s getting late, but here’s my number.” Adora went red again, and Catra laughed. “See you soon, Adora!” she called over her shoulder as she walked out of the bar.

Catra stopped at Finn's, a local seafood restaurant, for takeout on her way home. After picking up her food, she began walking again, but as she turned a corner, she was stopped by She-Ra. Catra froze. “What are you doing back in town, Weaver?”

“You must have the wrong cat, ma’am. I’m here to help rebuild.” Catra responded, still in her fake high-pitched voice. She-Ra narrowed her eyes.

“Mind taking off those glasses, then?” She-Ra countered. Catra took them off reluctantly, and then kneeled on the ground, hands behind her head. She-Ra’s eyes widened in surprise. The Catra she knew would *never* have surrendered. She stood there, watching Catra, trying to think of what Catra had planned, but had nothing. Perhaps Catra genuinely had no idea who she was?

Some kind of memory loss after the motorcycle crash? That would explain why she was helping with the reconstruction, not why she killed Tung Lashor and Double Trouble, or why she robbed that bank in Dryl.

"You gonna arrest me, She-Ra?" Catra muttered.

"N-no, I think I *did* have the wrong Magicat, please forgive me, Ms. Kyle." She-Ra spoke, before disappearing into an alley. Catra picked up her food and started walking again. ' *How did she know about my new name? And why did she let me go?* ' Catra thought to herself as she walked.

///// *She-Ra's POV*

"You let her go!?" Queen Green yelled through the communicator.

"Whoever she is, that is not Catra Weaver. I've been spying on her since she got into Bright Moon!" She-Ra responded.

"She *killed* the Golden Archer, our friend, and you let her go." Queen Green muttered furiously before hanging up. She-Ra sighed. Queen Green was right. Catra had killed the Golden Archer, but She-Ra wasn't sure that was Catra. Those eyes were unmistakable, but nothing else about her other than her race was anything like Catra Weaver. Selina Kyle was a hard-working, friendly woman who flirted with She-Ra, instead of actively trying to kill her. Selina Kyle's mismatched eyes had no evil rage behind

them, like Catra's did. Was it Catra after all, and she was just falling for an act? Or worse, could she have fallen for the Magicat?

After making sure no one was around, she sheathed her sword and transformed back into her normal, human self. She walked back to her house, pondering the events of the day. She sighed as she walked into the empty house. It wasn't the same without her best friend and roommate, Glimmer. It made her feel worse about letting Catra/Selina go, because she took out two of her closest friends as well as two thousand others. Adora just couldn't arrest her because everything about Selina was nothing like Catra. In fact, she was sure Catra would die before letting herself become anything like Selina. Maybe that motorcycle crash did more damage than the super squad had thought.

///// *Catra's POV, the next morning*

Catra hadn't slept much that night, trying to understand exactly what the fuck happened the night before. She-Ra caught her and then let her go, calling her by her new name, and none of it made any sense. She went into work like any other day though. She only spoke when one of the other construction workers spoke to her first, and drank a monster first thing in the morning. During her lunch break, she looked around the city. There was a lot less rubble and a lot more buildings than when she had arrived. Things were beginning to go back to normal for Bright Moon, even. The streets were no longer empty, and every other block sported a new building or two. At 5 o'clock, when Catra was done for the day, she received a text on her phone.

Unknown Number:

Hey Selina, it's Adora. Meet you at Johnny's?

Selina Kyle:

Sure, be there in 15!

Adora's text was the last thing she expected, but she felt so excited. She realized she had fallen for Adora, much harder than she suspected. She found herself running to the bar as quickly as her legs would take her. She stopped to catch her breath for a minute before walking inside as casually as she could. Adora sat at a booth this time, and Catra slid in across from her. "Hey, Adora."

"Hey, Selina."

"You'll never believe what happened to me last night!"

Adora's eyes widened. "What happened?" She asked, knowing exactly what Selina was about to say.

"I met She-Ra! She's beautiful! Not as beautiful as you, though." Catra flirted. Adora went bright red, again. She opened her mouth to speak but couldn't. Catra giggled. "Wow, I knew that would make you red, but speechless?" she continued to tease.

“Y-Yeah, it’s not, like, every day you get compared to, you know, a superhero,” Adora stammered, somehow getting even more red. Catra laughed heartily. The rest of the night was pretty fun, mostly laughs and Catra flirting, Adora being a blushy mess. Adora left after about an hour, and Catra stayed for an extra glass of whiskey.

Catra was pretty drunk by the time she walked home, so she wasn’t exactly paying attention. Especially not to the girl following her. Then, a vine grabbed Catra’s wrist and pulled her off the street and up onto a rooftop, causing the drunken cat to vomit.

“You have 5 seconds to surrender, Weaver!” Queen Green yelled.

“Oww…” Selina muttered, rubbing her wrist where the vine had yanked her. “This just happened yesterday! She-Ra thought I was Weaver too, I know there’s not many of us Magicats but I’m starting to think the Super Squad has a racism problem!” the Magicat drunkenly grumbled.

Queen Green’s eyes widened with shock. Maybe She-Ra was right, maybe this isn’t Catra. But, those mismatched eyes were a dead giveaway. If she wasn’t Catra, the last thing the Super Squad needed was a racism allegation. Then, Queen Green realized that during her thought process the drunken Magicat had dozed off. She sighed, before calling She-Ra. “Hey, She-Ra. I confronted ‘Selina’ but even when she’s stupidly drunk she acts nothing like Weaver. I owe you an apology.”

“Told you.” She-Ra muttered.

“However, she did fall asleep on this roof and I don’t know where she lives. Would you mind getting her home?” Queen Green pleaded.

She-Ra groaned loudly. “Fine, but you owe me.” She-Ra complained before hanging up the phone.

The next morning, Catra woke up to her alarm for work with a killer hangover. She scrambled out of bed and splashed some water in her face. “No more whiskey for you, Selina.” She murmured into the mirror.

Truths

Chapter Summary

Catra confesses to Adora that she used to be the infamous supervillain that destroyed Bright Moon

Chapter Notes

Last chapter, I hope this story was enjoyable to read.

After the month contract was over, Catra signed another one, again as Selina Kyle. She continued to go on dates with Adora, but she felt bad about hiding the fact that she used to be a horrible supervillain. One night, after a couple drinks at their usual bar, Catra decided Adora should know the truth.

"Hey, Adora, can I tell you something?"

"What's up, Selina?"

"Well, my name isn't Selina. It's Catra. Catra Weaver. I used to be a very different person, a horrible person, who destroyed this city. I like you, a lot, and I didn't want to keep secrets any longer. I understand if you don't want to go out with me anymore, though." Catra admitted.

"I know." Adora muttered.

“What do you mean, ‘you know’!?” Catra asked, whirling around on her feet to face Adora.

“I’ve known you are Catra Weaver since the first time I met you. Those eyes are unmistakable.”

“Then, why…?”

“Why did I continue to see you?”

“Yeah…”

“Well, at first I was trying to see if you had ulterior motives to come back to Bright Moon, I was watching you to make sure you wouldn’t cause more trouble. But, you never did any damage to the reconstruction effort, you did good work and you haven’t touched your gun in about a month.”

“How did you know about the rifle?”

“You’re not the only one with a secret, Cat.” Adora commented, before pulling Catra into a nearby alley. Once the coast was clear, Adora raised her hand to the sky and chanted some phrase. All of a sudden, a blinding golden light struck her, and when Catra’s eyes recovered, she was no longer looking at Adora, but the hero She-Ra. It all clicked together, why Adora’s voice had sounded familiar, how she knew about Catra, everything.

“ *You’re* She-Ra!?” Catra exclaimed.

“That’s me!” She-Ra chuckled, before Adora sheathed the sword and the golden light faded, as she transformed back into her regular form.

“Why would you give me your secret identity?” Catra asked, confused.

“Well, you may be Catra Weaver, but you haven’t been Crimson for some time. I’m betting you aren’t going to tell anyone or try anything. If I’m wrong, so be it.” she explained. “You took out Double Trouble, you have spent the last month helping to correct the damage you did to my city, and even when you’re blackout you haven’t had so much as an evil thought behind your eyes.”

Catra just stared at Adora in disbelief. This conversation had gone so much easier than she thought it would. “So… you’re not going to arrest me?”

“Well, you still have a lot to make up for, but who am I to say that you should spend your time in a jail cell over actually rebuilding Bright Moon? It took quite a bit of convincing to keep the rest of the Super Squad at bay, though.”

Suddenly, a memory jolted through Catra's brain. "Wait, so that night on the rooftop with Queen Green…?"

"Yeah, not a dream. I carried you home after you passed out."

"One more question, Adora. Why aren't you angry?"

"Well, I am angry. I hate you for what you did, every single day. However, I don't let it dictate my actions. I could give you a beating, or let you rot in a maximum security hole, but neither of those brings back The Golden Archer. Also, I dunno why, but I kind of like this new Catra. You're sweet, helpful, and honest. You're almost nothing like you used to be: crazed, hateful, and self-centered. I don't know what caused this, whether it be the bike crash or whatever Double Trouble did to you after the hospital escape, but I would like to see what happens when this new Catra thrives in her own way." Adora spoke. Catra's confusion melted away, and all she could think about was how awesome Adora was. She stepped forward, and rolled up onto her toes to lift her face towards Adora's. She paused and looked to see if Adora was okay with this, and noticed that Adora's face had gone as red as her signature jacket, but she leaned closer, and their lips touched.

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